

Nathan Thurmon

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EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine | *Bachelor of Science in Aerospace Engineering*

Expected June 2029

Honors: Dean's Honor List (2 quarters)

GPA: 3.59

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Thrust Vector Stabilized Model Rocket | Independent

October 2025 – Present

- Designed rocket body, electronics, and motor assembly integration using SolidWorks, OpenRocket, and C++
- Designed flight controller electronics: IMUs, ESP32 microcontroller, and battery management
- Implemented modular body structure to support iterative testing
- Simulated rocket PID stabilization in MATLAB

Fully Autonomous Rover | Engineering 7

September 2025 – March 2026

- Wrote Arduino navigation logic using IR sensor feedback to follow an unknown course
- Assembled and soldered all electronics, including motor, buck converter, IR sensors, and camera
- Iteratively tested and refined variables including motor speed, voltage, turning, and logic timing
- Worked with a team of 6 to integrate rover body, mechanics, telemetry, and software
- Final course time was 6.2 seconds (55%) shorter than initial version of program; finished 5th out of 16 teams in competition

LEADERSHIP

Media and Operations Chair | Engineers Without Borders at UC Irvine

December 2025 – Present

- Led project to modernize the club's website: set up site's back-end, SSL security, domain, theme
- Organized events promoting practical engineering skills: construction, CAD, and networking
- Worked with UCI to organize meeting announcement emails through the engineering department email system
- Assisted in collaborating with other engineering clubs (BMES, ASCE, OEL)

President and Founder | Astronomy Club at Placer High School

August 2023 – June 2025

- Founded in 2023 to offer all students the opportunity to explore, collaborate, and generate interest in the sciences at a school where those opportunities were not previously offered
- Dedicated 20+ hours every month outside of school to plan learning opportunities and events
- Drafted club charter and organized original membership drive, resulting in a consistent membership of 30

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, MATLAB, C++, ESP32 microcontrollers, Arduino, Back-End Web Development

Software: SolidWorks, Fusion 360, ArcGIS, WordPress, Visual Studio, Excel, PowerPoint

Language: English (native), Spanish (conversational)

Additional: Soldering, welding

VOLUNTEERING

Undergraduate Research Symposium Assistant | UROP UC Irvine

May 2026

- Guided researchers by answering logistical questions and directing them to the correct presentation zone
- Assisted with setup and takedown of poster assembly floor materials
- Aided VIP guests with information and check-in for research presentations

Election Aid Worker | Placer County Election Office

October 2024 – November 2024

- Assisted with the setup, management, and cleanup of the Placer County 2024 general election
- Focused on identifying voters, issuing ballots, and assisting voters with disabilities through the voting process
- Helped over 800 voters cast their ballots at our election location

WORK EXPERIENCE

Science Journalist | Lukupp – Berkeley, CA

July 2024 – October 2025

- Published original work targeted at graduating high school students
- Interviewed career professionals in biomedical and mechanical fields
- Published articles focused on career development, major choice, niche fields of study, and research